

MDStart

A PROVISIONAL ACCEPTANCE TO SGU



Try the 4-year School of Medicine Program via MDStart

MDStart is an **exceptional opportunity** for students to experience our School of Medicine via a **trial period**. All MDStart students are offered a **provisional acceptance** into the School of Medicine via MDStart by our committee on admissions.

MDStart students are **part of the SGU community** in the same manner as all other Term 1 MD4 program students. MDStart students will learn, live and study on our beautiful campus in Grenada.

A Mutually Beneficial Opportunity

MDStart students are given a **14-week trial period** during which they have an opportunity to confirm their interest and aptitude for medical school before having to make a full personal and financial commitment to the 4-year medical school program. The 14-week MDStart trial period allows for a natural and accurate **assessment of a student's readiness for medical school**.

No Immediate Tuition

MDStart students are **not required to pay any immediate tuition and fees and are not eligible to receive Federal Direct Loans** (eligible US students) until they successfully complete the trial period and choose to enroll in the MD4 program. MDStart is a great way for students to **confirm their commitment and aptitude for medicine** before having to make a full personal and financial commitment to the MD4 program.

Fully Integrated into SGU Community

MDStart is offered on the Grenada campus of SGU for in-person learning only. MDStart students are **part of the SGU community** in the same manner as all other Term 1 MD4 program students. MDStart students are distributed across all Colleges and Term 1 MD4 program classes and have **access to all the same curricular and co-curricular benefits, student services, and student support**.

Academic Progression

MDStart students take the **same courses and exams** as other MD4 students. MDStart students who have a **passing average score greater than 69.5** across the first four exams of Term 1 are offered full admission to the MD4 program and can continue with the remainder of Term 1 as a regularly enrolled student.

FAQs

What will I need to do to earn a full acceptance to the SGU SOM MD4 program?

To earn your full acceptance, you must successfully complete MDStart and confirm your intention to enroll. A successful trial period is defined as **maintaining good academic standing** after the 14 weeks of attendance; having achieved an **average score of greater than 69.5** across the first four Term 1 exams and remaining compliant with all university rules.

MDStart students who complete their trial period successfully will be **granted a regular full acceptance** and can continue with the remainder of Term 1 as a regularly enrolled student.

Are there any costs to attend the MD4 program via MDStart?

Students attend the MD4 program via MDStart **without incurring immediate tuition and fees** or receiving Federal Title IV student assistance/Canadian Student Aid.

During the trial period students are responsible for the **cost of books, travel, lodging, food, and health insurance**.

MDStart students who successfully complete the trial period and choose to enroll in the MD4 program will complete the remainder of Term 1 and will be assessed tuition/fees for all of MD4 Term 1 and **become eligible to receive Federal**

Direct Loan funds (eligible US students)/Canadian Student Aid (eligible Canadian students), providing the students meet the eligibility criteria.

Students will need to **complete their Federal Direct Loan documentation requirements** before check-in to assure there are no issues with receipt of funds if they successfully complete the trial period. These funds will be on hold until the completion of the trial period and enrollment in the MD4 program. If the student does not enroll in the MD4 program, the student's Federal Direct Loans will not be processed or disbursed by SGU.

Am I able to receive US Federal Direct Loans/ Canadian Student Aid during MDStart?

No. During the MDStart trial period, you are not considered a regular student for US Federal Direct Loan/Canadian Student Aid eligibility purposes. However, if you successfully complete the trial period and **choose to enroll in the MD-4 program, you will gain eligibility for US Federal Direct Loans/Canadian Student Aid** for the entire trial period and the remaining portion of Term 1. Federal Direct Loan/Canadian Student Aid eligibility varies by student and you must meet with the Financial Aid Office to **determine your individual eligibility**. US Federal Direct Loan funds will be on hold until you complete the trial period and enroll in the MD4 program. If the student does not enroll in the MD4 program, the student's Federal Direct Loans will not be processed or disbursed by SGU.





Loans/Canadian Student Aid for the entire trial period and the remaining portion of Term 1. Federal Direct Loan/Canadian Student Aid eligibility varies by student and you must meet with the Financial Aid Office to **determine your individual eligibility**. US Federal Direct Loan funds will be on hold until you complete the trial period and enroll in the MD4 program. If the student does not enroll in the MD4 program, the student's Federal Direct Loans will not be processed or disbursed by SGU.

Can I receive an in-school deferment of my existing federal student loans during MDStart?

No, you are **not considered an enrolled student for in-school loan deferment purposes** until the successful completion of MDStart and enrollment in the MD4 program. Upon enrollment in the MD4 program, your in-school deferment will be reported effective as of the start date of the trial period.

Will regularly admitted Term 1 students know that I am in the MDStart Program?

No. MDStart students are **never identified** to faculty or fellow students. MDStart students are **fully integrated** into all Colleges and Term 1 classes and are afforded all the same curricular

and co-curricular benefits and support. The only exception is MDStart students **may not repeat the course for academic reasons** (what SGU calls a "credit remediation"). The provisional acceptance requires that students succeed academically during their trial period.

Is MDStart being offered online?

MDStart is only offered to students in person at the **Grenada campus**. There is **no online version** of MDStart.

What if I am unsuccessful or choose not to continue with MDStart?

For students who do not achieve the necessary academic success in MDStart, or who choose not to enroll in the MD4 program after the trial period, there will be **no tuition or fees assessed and no academic credit will be awarded for the trial period**.

NEXT STEPS

Learn more about the MDStart program. Please contact Laura Bruno, Dean, Student Enrollment at lbruno1@sgu.edu.



St. George's University
SCHOOL OF MEDICINE

Grenada, West Indies